



China advanced manufacturing

Global Markets Research

4 September 2026

EQUITY: TECHNOLOGY

Shenzhen tour takeaways

Computing power and data are likely binding constraints for China's embodied-AI

During 2–3 September 2026, we conducted a two-day advanced manufacturing tour in Shenzhen, meeting seven companies across the advanced manufacturing / humanoid robotics chain — from foundation-model and hardware players through to the listed component and assembly suppliers that sit underneath them. Three takeaways cut across the entire trip: i) the binding constraint has moved to computing power and real-machine data; ii) customer coverage is comprehensive, while robot revenue remains immaterial; and iii) consolidation is likely in 2027E, based on companies' feedback.

Lens Technology: 200 robotics clients and investment in data collection

Lens Technology (300433 CH, Not rated) new businesses are opening on several fronts: i) its robotics business has 200 customers and thousands of humanoid units were shipped in 2025, a Kunshan plant dedicated to one robotic client with solid shipment guidance; ii) management views the bottleneck in physical AI is real-world data — even one simple vertical scene may need at least 1,000 hours of high-quality real-machine data; therefore, it has invested in several data-collection companies and is building an embodied-AI simulation compute center; iii) in the aerospace segment, Lens continues to supply to SpaceX (SPCX US, Not rated) Starlink ground terminals (low-dielectric reflector plus structural parts, ~CNY200–300mn annually) and was the earliest developer of UTG (ultra-thin glass) flexible solar wings.

Zhaowei Machinery & Electronic: Robotics revenue remains small

Zhaowei Machinery & Electronic's (003021 CH, Not rated) robotics revenue remains small — CNY23mn in 2025 and CNY16mn in 1H26 — spanning dexterous hands and motor modules with three key clients from both the US and China. In addition, the robot gearbox gross margin is higher than the company's blended gross margin. Its Thailand Phase-one is a USD15mn investment, which may support CNY300–400mn of annual output value, with the building complete and equipment landing for production within the year. Furthermore, on the AI device side, the company is working with a US AI customer on a 6mm motor.

Everwin Precision: Embodied-AI segment is the fastest growth business

Everwin Precision's (300115 CH, Not rated) robotics customer list spans US players and China leading firms. For one US client, its content value could reach low tens of thousands, and management expects the price will further decline once volume ramps up. In addition, the Yaskawa (6506 JP, Buy) JV, Tianji, has been deconsolidated, and has become an Everwin customer — designing dual arms and cerebellum algorithms while Everwin manufactures — and Everwin has taken on whole-machine assembly, expanding robot capacity more than fivefold within four quarters. On the satellite side, the company makes ground-terminal structural parts for one client with content value of a few hundred CNY per unit.

Huayan Robotics: Aiming to be China's largest arm vendor

Huayan Robotics' (1021 HK, Not rated) cobot payload has gone from 5–10kg to 60kg, with accompanying gains in precision and speed opening dispensing, cutting and precision welding. The positioning is deliberately "everything except the brain": joints (harmonic, dual-flexspline harmonic, RV, planetary, linear), frameless torque motors, servo drives, motion control and cerebellum-layer algorithms, layered with torque sensors, 3D vision and electronic skin — a physical-AI base layer, with the brain left to partners. In addition, management guides to CNY200–300mn of humanoid-related revenue next year, with the largest customer at around CNY50mn. In addition, it launched its humanoid arm in April: several dozen customers are queueing but supply is minimal (one unit each); at

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CNY40–50k per arm and 3,000–4,000 units, management estimates that it could contribute close to CNY100–200mn next year, and management believes it can become China's largest humanoid arm firm within one-to-two years.

PaXini: Scale-up in tactile hardware

PaXini (unlisted) is one of the leading players in tactile sensing and has the world's largest tactile data production base, with facilities in Tianjin, Suqian and Wuhan each above 10,000 sqm, according to management. The technology choice is a Hall-effect array, which management argues best balances cost, industrial durability and scene coverage; it has taken tactile sensors from the CNY100k-plus lab pricing of the era of overseas monopoly down to a CNY199 entry price, with a single sensor resolving 15 dimensions of human-like tactile information. Further, a ~20,000 sqm "super" facility in Suqian has just been completed, the company is the only one in China to have completed compliant cross-border data export, and it has participated deeply in drafting national standards.

LimX Dynamics: The year humanoids had to answer "Who buys this?"

LimX Dynamics (unlisted) management's framing is that 2026E is the first year the industry can answer whether humanoids generate economic value, and it points to three live customer cases as evidence: a US construction integrator mounting TRON 2 dual arms on a Kuka (unlisted) arm for data-centre construction work (teleoperated, with the customer explicitly collecting vertical construction data it regards as its own); SAIC's (600104 CH, Rating suspended) Qingdao warehouse using full-size humanoids purely to capture worker-operation data via PICO teleoperation; and a Suzhou integrator deploying TRON with an arm and LiDAR (light detection and ranging) for underground utility-tunnel inspection. In addition, management commented that a general humanoid foundation model is a job for large players, not a startup constrained by data and computing power.

AI² Robotics: CNY700mn orders; breakeven in 2029E

AI² Robotics (unlisted) focuses on three commercialisation areas — high cleanliness, high flexibility, high margin — which has shipped to HKC (001399 CH, Not rated) and, in 1H26, BOE (000725 CH, Buy), plus Huaxi Biotech (688363 CH, Not rated) in biopharma. In public services, robots run day shifts at Guangzhou Baiyun airport with deployments across ten major domestic airports, night-shift testing at Hong Kong airport. On financials and capacity: average robot ASP is CNY400–500k; 2026E year's orders are ~CNY700mn against ~CNY500mn revenue, with backlog in the high hundreds of millions. On its shipment mix, more than half are related to industrial, and airport and consumer service are at ~30%; the existing production lines run at 2,000 units a year against a 10k-unit line under construction. The company guides to breakeven around 2029E.

Appendix A-1

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